

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 127 OF 153

# Shatranj Kamil

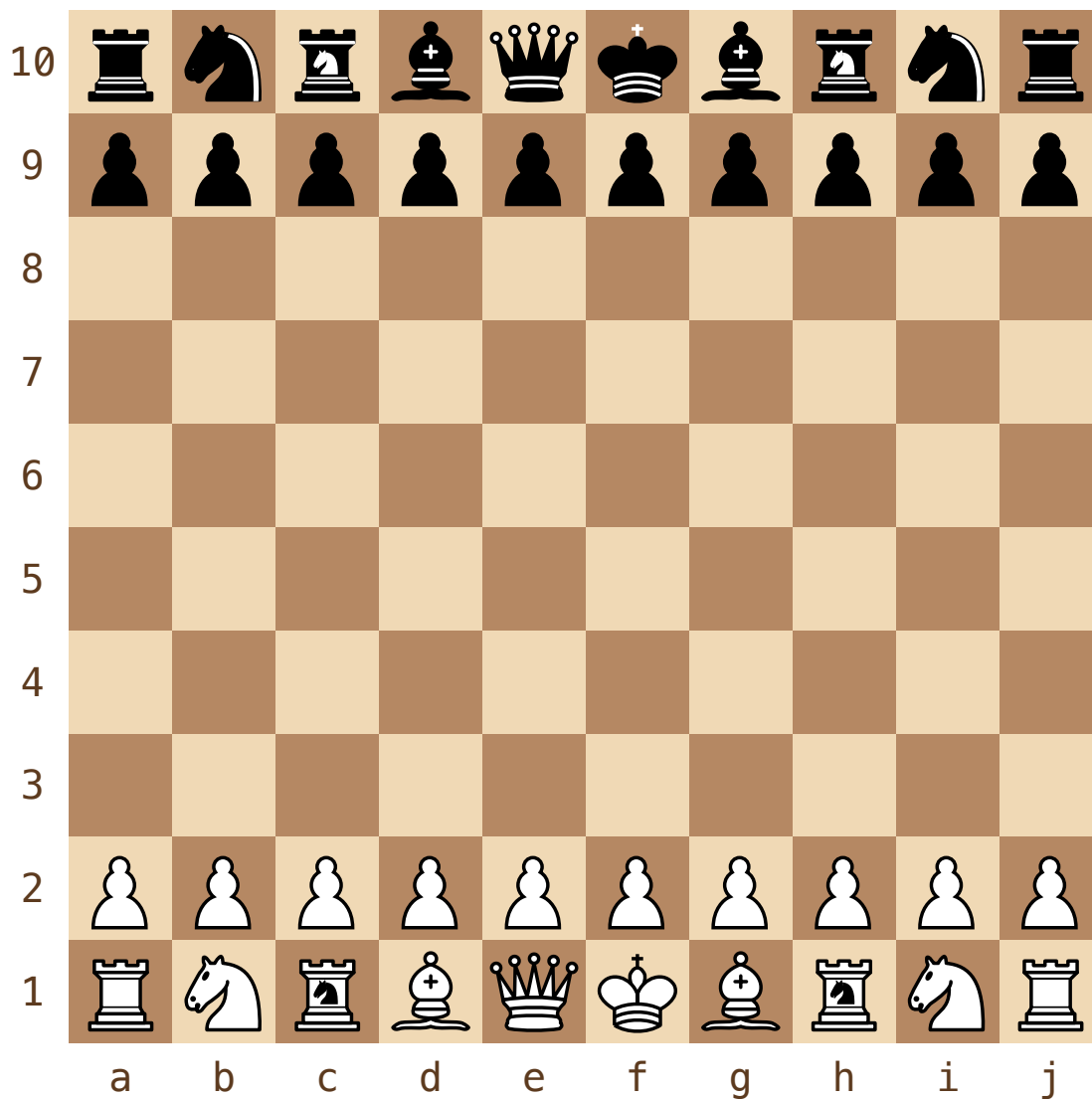
**10×10**

BOARD

**2**

PLAYERS

## SHATRANJ KAMIL



*Shatranj Kamil – starting position*

<https://engine.moddable.games/play/?game=moddable-chess&variant=shatranj-kamil>

Shatranj Kamil (شطرنج كامل, “Complete Chess” or “Perfect Chess”) is a historical Arabic chess variant approximately 1000 years old, described by John Gollon based on Murray’s reconstruction from an old manuscript. It expands the standard Shatranj board from 8×8 to 10×10 and adds two War Machine (Dabbabah) pieces per side, plus two extra Pawns.

Two historical versions are documented on chessvariants.com: one adds a Camel piece (shkam1), the other – documented here – adds a War Machine (shkam2). The War Machine version has the unusual rule that the piece moves as a King but is immune to check.

## THE BOARD

10 files (a–j) × 10 ranks = 100 squares.

## STARTING POSITION

**White (rank 1):** Rook a1 · Knight b1 · Elephant c1 · War Machine d1 · King e1 · General f1 · War Machine g1 · Elephant h1 · Knight i1 · Rook j1

**White pawns (rank 2):** a2–j2 (10 pawns)

**Black (rank 10):** Rook a10 · Knight b10 · Elephant c10 · War Machine d10 · King e10 · General f10 · War Machine g10 · Elephant h10 · Knight i10 · Rook j10

**Black pawns (rank 9):** a9–j9 (10 pawns)

## PIECES

Standard Shatranj pieces plus the War Machine:

| PIECE                         | ARABIC | MOVEMENT                                                                          |
|-------------------------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| King (Shah)                   | شاه    | One square in any direction                                                       |
| General (Firzan)              | فرزان  | One square diagonally                                                             |
| Elephant (Fil)                | فيل    | Leaps exactly 2 squares diagonally; can jump the intervening square               |
| Knight (Faras)                | فرس    | L-shaped leap (as in standard chess)                                              |
| Rook (Rukh)                   | رخ     | Slides any distance orthogonally                                                  |
| Pawn                          | بيدق   | One square forward; captures one square diagonally; no double first step          |
| <b>War Machine (Dabbabah)</b> | دبابة  | Moves one square in any direction (as a King) but is <b>not affected by check</b> |

## PROMOTION

A Pawn reaching the last rank promotes to a General — **only if the player currently has no General on the board**. If the player still has a General, the Pawn reaching the last rank is **removed from the board** without promotion.

## SPECIAL RULES

- ♦ **No castling, no en passant.**
- ♦ **No bare King rule** — the game continues normally even when one player has only the King remaining.
- ♦ **Win:** Checkmate the opponent's King, or stalemate the opponent (stalemate is a win for the stalemating player).

## ATTRIBUTION

Shatranj Kamil (War Machine version) documented at [chessvariants.com/historic.dir/shkam2.html](https://chessvariants.com/historic.dir/shkam2.html) (Hans Bodlaender, from Gollon/Murray). Camel version at [chessvariants.com/historic.dir/shkam1.html](https://chessvariants.com/historic.dir/shkam1.html).